1. Hot reservoir (or) Source: It supplies heat to the engine. It is always maintained at a high temperature T_H

2. Working substance: It is a substance like gas or water, which converts the heat supplied into work.

   A simple example of a heat engine is a steam engine. In olden days steam engines were used to drive trains. The working substance in these is water which absorbs heat from the burning of coal. The heat converts the water into steam. This steam is does work by rotating the wheels of the train, thus making the train move.

3. Cold reservoir (or) Sink: The heat engine ejects some amount of heat (Q_L) in to cold reservoir after it doing work. It is always maintained at a low temperature T_L.

   For example, in the automobile engine, the cold reservoir is the surroundings at room temperature. The automobile ejects heat to these surroundings through a silencer.

The heat engine works in a cyclic process. After a cyclic process it returns to the same state. Since the heat engine returns to the same state after it ejects heat, the change in the internal energy of the heat engine is zero.

The efficiency of the heat engine is defined as the ratio of the work done (out put) to the heat absorbed (input) in one cylic process.

Let the working substance absorb heat Q_H units from the source and reject Q_L units to the sink after doing work W units, as shown in the Figure 8.43.

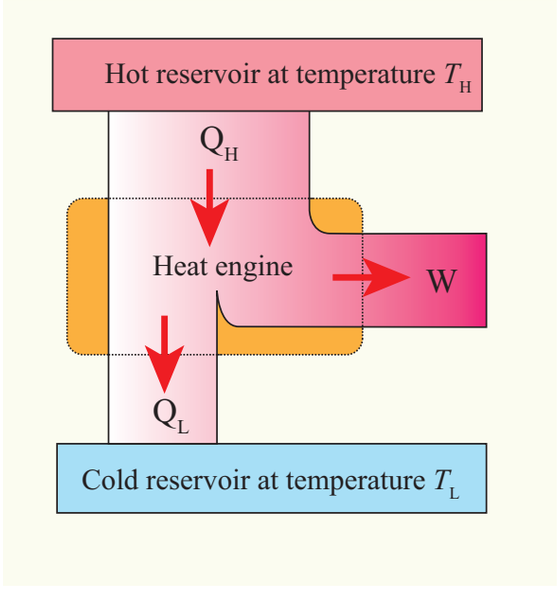


Figure 8.43 Heat engine

We can write
Input heat = Work done + ejected heat

$$Q_H = W + Q_L$$

$$W = Q_H - Q_L$$

Then the efficiency of heat engine

$$\eta = \frac{output}{input} = \frac{W}{Q_H} = \frac{Q_H - Q_L}{Q_H}$$

$$\eta = \frac{output}{input} = \frac{W}{Q_H} = 1 - \frac{Q_L}{Q_H} \qquad (8.55)$$

Note here that Q_H, Q_L and W all are taken as positive, a sign convention followed in this expression.

Since $Q_L < Q_H$, the efficiency (η) always less than 1. This implies that heat absorbed is not completely converted into work. The second law of thermodynamics placed fundamental restrictions on converting heat completely into work.

We can state the heat engine statement of second law of thermodynamics. This is also called Kelvin-Planck's statement.

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